

MANY POORER PEOPLE BOUGHT FOOD FROM "FAST-FOOD" SHOPS LIKE THIS ONE IN POMPEII. HOT AND COLD FOOD WAS SERVED FROM POTTERY JARS SUNK INTO THE TOPS OF COUNTERS.

your noisy neighbors had kept you awake in your apartment, it was time to rise and shine and get dressed. Before the day's work began, there was just enough time to grab a cup of water and a mouthful of food for the first meal of the day, usually something cold from the previous night. The midday meal was much the same—



more of yesterday's leftovers, or a piece of bread and some fruit. It was really just a snack.

The main meal of the day was dinner (*cena*). For the rich, this was a feast that might start at three in the afternoon and go on until late at night. It was eaten, after the daily bath, in the dining room (*triclinium*). On three sides of the room were low couches where the family and their guests reclined, lying on their left sides. In the middle was a table on which the food was placed—and lots of it. Some banquets had separate courses of fish, snails, meat, vegetables, birds, fruit, nuts, and pastries. Adults drank plenty of wine, too.

Time for a bath

People didn't bother to wash when they woke up, since they knew they'd be taking a bath later in the day—and what a bath it was! Only the poshest of houses had bathrooms, so most people cleaned up

